

EZRA EDU

Child Strategic Plan Diagnostic

A formation-based equipping plan
grounded in the nine enhancements

Companion to How We Educate Children and Develop Talent
Will & Donna Meier

How to Use This Diagnostic

Education is never neutral. Information is not formation. See the child before you shape the child.

This is a strategic plan, not a worksheet. It maps the nine enhancements from *How We Educate Children and Develop Talent* onto one specific child you are forming. You can complete it alone, with a co-parent or co-teacher, or alongside Ezra Edu — the AI coaching agent trained on the book.

Three convictions shape this work:

- Every child carries a designed problem they were built to solve.
- The bar does not drop. The doorway gets wider.
- Formation is not delegable. The adult in front of the child carries something no system can replace.

Work through the sections in order. Do not rush. Each section asks you to see this child a little more clearly. If you do not know the answer, that itself is information — Ezra Edu can walk you through observation questions to bring the answer to the surface.

Review the plan every ninety days. Children grow non-linearly. The plan should adapt as they reveal more of who they were made to be.

Child Snapshot

Child's Name:

Age and Grade:

Primary Setting: Homeschool Private Public Co-op Other

Lead Adult(s):

Plan Started:

Next Review (90 days):

One sentence that describes who this child is right now:

What you most want for this child five years from now:

SECTION 1

Gifting and Passion

Orientation and the Designed Problem

Gifting tells you what this child can do. Passion tells you what they will not quit. Together they point to the kind of problem this child was designed to solve in the world.

What does this child do well without being told?

What lights them up under challenge — what do they not quit?

What kind of problem does this child seem designed to solve?

- Organize
- Empathize
- Innovate
- Analyze
- Lead
- Build
- Repair
- Other

Top three observed gifts (specific, not generic):

1.

2.

3.

Current passion(s) — what they return to without being forced:

Action This Season

One real-world exposure connected to gifting:

One person who can mirror this gift back to the child:

SECTION 2

Multiple Intelligences

The bar does not drop. The doorway gets wider.

Rate this child's natural strength in each domain on a scale of 1 to 5, where 5 is strongest. Note evidence — a moment, a habit, an unprompted choice that reveals the intelligence.

Intelligence	Strength 1–5	Evidence / Notes
Linguistic (words, reading, writing)		
Logical-Mathematical (patterns, reasoning)		
Spatial (visual, design, navigation)		
Bodily-Kinesthetic (movement, hands-on)		
Musical (rhythm, melody, sound)		
Interpersonal (reading people, leading)		
Intrapersonal (self-awareness, reflection)		
Naturalistic (living systems, environment)		

Top two doorways — lead instruction through these:

One weak domain to gently expand (not force):

SECTION 3

Adversity as a Teacher

Challenge is not removed. It is stewarded.

Children do not auto-extract meaning from hardship. The adult interprets the challenge. The interpretation shapes whether adversity becomes formation or wound.

Current real challenges this child is facing (academic, social, emotional, spiritual):

1.

2.

3.

Hidden curriculum each challenge could teach (resilience, perseverance, humility, courage, discernment):

How adversity is currently being interpreted in this child's hearing:

Dead end / unfair

Training ground / formation

One framing adjustment to make this season:

One challenge to lean into rather than rescue from:

SECTION 4

Shepherd the Heart

Formation before performance.

Behavior flows from the heart. Managing behavior without shepherding the heart produces compliance without character. The heart is the soil. Everything else grows from it.

What does this child currently love?

What does this child currently fear?

What does this child want to be true about themselves?

Where is performance being mistaken for formation in our adult relationship with this child?

One conversation to have this week — not about behavior, but about the heart underneath:

Heart Rhythms to Establish

- One weekly intentional heart conversation
- One regular way the child sees their primary adult receive correction with grace
- One regular practice of confession, repair, and restoration in the home

SECTION 5

Learning Pathways

Use the doorway first, then expand the house.

Primary pathway:	Visual	Auditory	Kinesthetic	Read/Write
Also consider:	Conversational	Project-based		
Secondary pathway:				

Subject this child is currently stuck in:

Try this pathway instead this week:

Environmental Adjustments

Light:

Sound:

Time of day they think best:

Body posture (sitting, standing, moving):

One two-week experiment to run:

SECTION 6

Activate Creativity

Creativity connects students to meaning.

Every child carries creative capacity. Most children are not born with low creativity — they are born into environments that quiet it. The adult's job is to protect the conditions in which creativity can come out.

Current state of this child's creativity: Flourishing Present but quiet Suppressed Underdeveloped

What blocks it (be specific):

Three weekly creativity practices to install:

1.

2.

3.

One creative project this child will own start-to-finish in the next 60 days:

SECTION 7

Humor

A signal of safety, security, and health.

Humor is diagnostic. It tells you whether the room is safe. When laughter rises, learning rises with it. When humor turns into mockery or shame, the room has closed.

In the last 90 days, this child's laughter has: Increased Stayed the same Decreased

What changed?

Where in the day does humor appear naturally?

Where has humor been wounded (sarcasm, mockery, shame-based teasing)?

Repair needed:

One adult-modeled habit of light-heartedness to recover:

SECTION 8

Group Projects

Socialization, collaboration, and contribution.

This child's current group role:	Initiator	Connector	Builder	Encourager
	Quality-checker	Observer	Disrupter	Avoider

Strengths in collaboration:

Gaps in collaboration:

One Real Group Project in the Next 90 Days

What:

Their role:

A role they do not default to that they should try:

Skills to Coach During This Project

- Voicing respectful disagreement
- Receiving correction without withdrawing
- Leading without controlling
- Following without disappearing
- Repairing after conflict

SECTION 9

Train Critical Thinking

Discern roots, assumptions, and outcomes.

Current critical thinking baseline:	Accepts most at face value	Asks why naturally
	Skeptical without grounding	Beginning to test claims

Inputs Currently Shaping This Child the Most

Screens:

Peers:

Algorithms / platforms:

Adults outside the home:

Books / curriculum:

One low-pressure critical-thinking rep to install this week:

Six Questions to Teach This Child to Ask of Any Claim

1. Who is saying this?
2. What are they assuming?
3. What is the evidence?
4. What is the alternative?
5. What is at stake — for them, and for me?
6. Does this hold up when I bring it to Scripture?

Putting It All Together

A formation plan does not have to be complicated. It does need to be intentional.

Top three formation priorities for this child for the next 90 days:

1.

2.

3.

Weekly Rhythm We Will Hold

One conversation about strengths and passion + one real-world exposure

One intentional heart conversation

One learning-pathway experiment

One creative project moment

One challenge held (not rescued from)

One collaborative project touchpoint

One critical-thinking rep

Primary Adult Accountable for Each Priority

Priority 1:

Priority 2:

Priority 3:

What we will stop doing (something must go for something new to begin):

Identity Declaration

What This Child Carries Into Adulthood

Every child carries an unspoken question into adulthood: did anyone really see me? Speak these words. Speak them often. Speak them out loud.

Three things we want this child to know we see in them:

1.

2.

3.

Scripture or promise we will speak over this child this season:

One sentence describing who this child is becoming:

Review Cadence

Children grow non-linearly. The plan adapts as the child reveals more of who they were made to be.

Checkpoint	What's Working	What's Not	Adjustment
Month 1			
Month 2			
Month 3 — Plan Refresh			

Notes from coaching with Ezra Edu (patterns, insights, things to track):

Continue with Ezra Edu

Once you have completed this diagnostic, bring it into Ezra Edu and ask it to walk through the plan with you. Ezra Edu will coach you through each enhancement, help you find what you cannot yet see, and adapt the plan as your child grows.

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This plan is a tool, not a verdict. The Spirit forms the carrier. The carrier forms the child. Ezra Edu walks alongside.

Forming. Gathering. Releasing.

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